The Fear of Being 'Ordinary'

STUDENT'S NOTES



Eng Hub

Licence issued for personal use, 37881, Rawat Praveen

Read the article and pay attention to the words in bold. Check their meanings in this Quizlet set. You can use them during the speaking club to express your ideas.

Keep reading on the next slide.

DO YOU FEAR BEING NORMAL?



Have you ever worried that your life is a bit **ordinary**? To avoid this feeling, some people try not to live in a typical way. They want their life to be special.

Maybe you work very hard to be successful. Maybe you dream about becoming a popular influencer. Or maybe you travel a lot to have exciting experiences.

You may not like the idea of being **average**. But even if you achieve many things, it can still feel like it is not enough. If this sounds familiar, you might have something called **koinophobia**. It means the fear of being ordinary.

This fear can have some good sides. It can motivate people to do amazing things. However, if it becomes too strong, it can also **harm your mental health**. So where does this fear come from, and how can we control it?



Why do people feel this fear?

Experts say this fear often comes from the idea that we must be special to be loved and accepted. People with **low self-confidence** may feel they are not good enough if they live a normal life.

Social media can make this feeling stronger. Today, we can easily see what other people are doing in their lives. We see influencers, successful careers, and perfect holidays. Because of this, we may feel **pressure to achieve the same things**.

Social media can make normal life look boring. At the same time, it shows exciting lifestyles and big achievements. This can make us feel that our own life is not good enough.

Because of this, people may start **chasing bigger and bigger goals**. They believe they must do something extraordinary to live a good life.

Licence issued for personal use, 37881, Rawat Praveen

Read the article and pay attention to the words in bold. Check their meanings in this Quizlet set. You can use them during the speaking club to express your ideas.

But this way of thinking can **cause problems**. It can stop people from doing things that might truly make them happy. For example, someone might want to stay in their hometown or choose a simple job that gives them a stable life.
It can also create a lot of stress and pressure. Many people **experience burnout** because they feel they must **succeed in every area of life**.

It's OK to be average.
If the fear of being ordinary is **affecting your mental health**, it is important to change how you think.
Experts say it helps to **focus more on your own values** instead of trying to **impress** others. When you stop **looking for approval** from other people, you can better understand what you really want in life.
It is also helpful to remember that success does not always **increase self-worth**. Even very successful people can still feel unhappy.
Accepting your imperfections can help you feel better about yourself. This does not mean you should stop having goals. It is still good to have something to work towards.
For example, you might plan a trip with friends, **take part** in a local event, or simply enjoy small moments in daily life. It could be drinking coffee in the morning or reading a good book before bed.
Sometimes we look so much for extraordinary experiences that we forget the value of simple things. But a normal life can also be meaningful and beautiful.

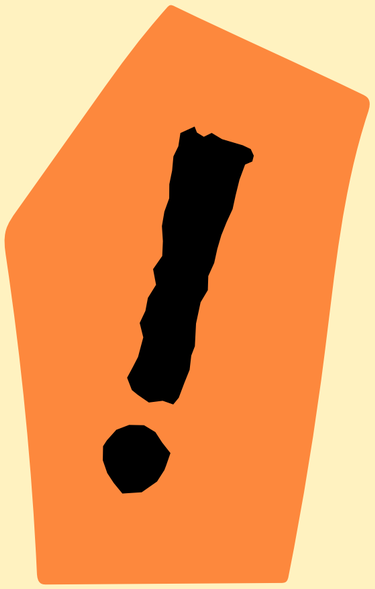




Adaptation of https://happiful.com/koinophobia-we-explore-the-fear-behind-being

Licence issued for personal use, 37881, Rawat Praveen

Practise!



1. Use this Quizlet set to learn, practise and revise the words and expressions from the article.

2. Try this interactive exercise to check your understanding of the new vocabulary and practise using it.

Eng Hub

Licence issued for personal use, 37881, Rawat Praveen

Useful phrases for discussion:

These two slides have a lot of useful phrases to help you explain your ideas. You can open this file during the speaking club and use them.

Reacting to ideas:

- That makes sense.
- I see what you mean.
- You've got a point there.
- I hadn't thought about it like that.

Adding an idea:

- I'd also add that...
- Another thing to consider is...
- What's more, ...
- It also depends on...

Responding / encouraging:

- Why do you think that?
- Could you explain that a bit more?
- What do you mean by that?
- Can you give an example?

Giving reasons / examples:

- The reason I think this is...
- For instance, ...
- A good example of this is...
- This is because...

Eng Hub

Licence issued for personal use, 37881, Rawat Praveen

Useful phrases for discussion:

These two slides have a lot of useful phrases to help you explain your ideas. You can open this file during the speaking club and use them.

Agreeing:

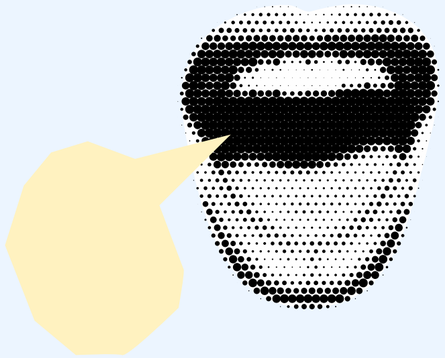
- I think that's an excellent point.
- I'd agree with that.
- That's exactly how I see it.
- I was thinking the same thing.
- That's true to a certain extent.
- I can see why you think that.

Disagreeing:

- I'm not sure I see it that way.
- I see what you mean, but I'd say...
- I'm not sure about that.
- I don't quite agree with that.
- That might be true, but...
- I see your point, but for me...

Ranking / prioritising:

- I'd say this is more important than the others.
- This would probably come first for me.
- I'd put this higher on the list.
- This isn't as important as the others.
- This would be lower on my list.
- It really depends on the situation.
- If I had to choose, I'd go for...
- This stands out as the most important because...



Eng Hub

Licence issued for personal use, 37881, Rawat Praveen